

Automating Data Import and
Relationship Mapping
using Import Sets and Dot Walking

Introduction

- Organizations handle large volumes of data from different sources.
- Importing this data manually can lead to errors and delays.
- Automation helps streamline the process.
- Import Sets and Dot Walking are commonly used techniques in ServiceNow to automate data import and relationship mapping.

Objectives

- Automate data import from external sources.
- Ensure accurate data mapping between tables.
- Reduce manual work and human errors.
- Improve data consistency and integrity.
- Increase operational efficiency.

What are Import Sets?

- Import Sets are temporary tables used to import data from external systems.
- They act as a staging area before data is inserted into target tables.
- Data can be imported from Excel, CSV files, or databases.
- Import sets help validate and transform data before final storage.

Transform Maps

- Transform Maps define how data moves from Import Set tables to target tables.
- They control field mapping between source and destination.
- They allow data transformation and validation.
- Scripts can be added for advanced logic.

What is Dot Walking?

- Dot Walking is used to access fields from related tables.
- It allows retrieving data through reference fields.
- Example: `incident.caller_id.email`
- This improves data relationships and reporting.

Workflow of Data Import

- 1. Upload data file (Excel/CSV).
- 2. Create an Import Set table.
- 3. Load data into the Import Set.
- 4. Configure Transform Map.
- 5. Run transformation.
- 6. Data moves into the target table.

Benefits

- Faster data import process.
- Reduced manual errors.
- Improved data relationships.
- Better data management.
- Efficient system integration.

Example Scenario

- Import employee data from Excel.
- Map employee ID, department, and manager fields.
- Use dot walking to connect employee to department table.
- Data automatically populates related records.

Conclusion

- Automating data import improves efficiency.
- Import Sets provide a controlled staging area.
- Transform Maps ensure proper data mapping.
- Dot Walking helps maintain relationships between tables.
- These techniques improve system performance and data accuracy.